

Michigan Building Codes

Building codes are designed to result in safe, sanitary, and healthy construction for building occupants. Before a developer can build or renovate a building, a permit from the local governmental authority must be obtained.

The permit is usually posted on the job site, and at various phases of completion, a building inspector from the local governmental authority will inspect the property to verify that the building is being constructed to local code.

Prior to the building being occupied, a final permit and a certificate of occupancy (C of O) must be obtained. In some communities, a C of O is required for all properties, regardless of whether there has been new construction or renovation. An inspection is conducted to determine whether the building is fit for occupancy or whether corrections are needed.

In some municipalities in Michigan, a city certification is required when a building changes hands. The city certification, provided after satisfactory inspection, certifies that the property complies with local building codes, including electrical, plumbing, heating, and structural. In areas where a city certification is required, approval must be obtained prior to closing.